



COMP3153/9153

Algorithmic Verification

Lecture 11: Abstract Interpretation and Static Analysis

Static Analysis

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Most tools aren't sound nor complete, because they're a mixture.

Abstract Interpretation

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We have seen this before. *Predicate abstraction* is an example of abstract interpretation.

The WHILE Language

To make things easier, we will define a simple imperative programming language as follows:

$$\begin{array}{ll} \mathcal{A} & ::= \langle \textit{arithmetic expressions} \rangle \\ \mathcal{B} & ::= \langle \textit{boolean expressions} \rangle \\ \mathcal{S} & ::= [x := \mathcal{A}]^\ell \mid [\textbf{skip}]^\ell \mid \mathcal{S}_1; \mathcal{S}_2 \\ & \quad \mid \textbf{if } [\mathcal{B}]^\ell \textbf{ then } \mathcal{S} \textbf{ else } \mathcal{S} \\ & \quad \mid \textbf{while } [\mathcal{B}]^\ell \textbf{ do } \mathcal{S} \end{array}$$

Note that we *label* all statements and conditions (usually with a number). These labelled terms correspond to nodes on the control flow graph.

Examples

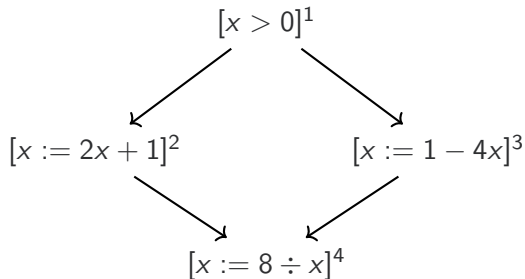
```

if  $[x > 0]^1$  then
     $[x := 2x + 1]^2$ 
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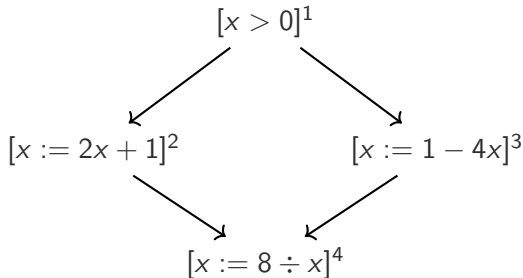
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What **abstract domain**
should we use to detect
divide by zero?

Intervals

Let's define intervals n, m as either:

- $\emptyset$, the empty interval, or
- $[n, m]$ where $n, m \in \mathbb{Z} \cup \{+\infty, -\infty\}$.

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Observation

Define $\inf S = \bigcap S$ and $\sup S = \bigcup S$, then intervals form a lattice: $\perp = \emptyset$ and $\top = [-\infty, +\infty]$. The ordering $\preceq$ here is interval inclusion.

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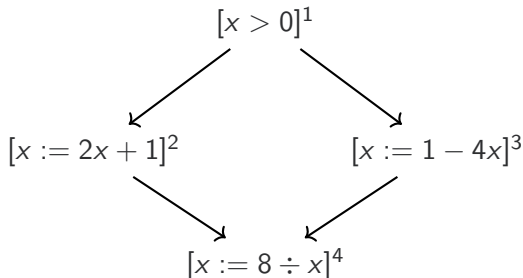
Define $\inf S = \bigcap S$ and $\sup S = \bigcup S$, then intervals form a lattice: $\perp = \emptyset$ and $\top = [-\infty, +\infty]$. The ordering $\preceq$ here is interval inclusion.

We can “lift” arithmetic operators to the interval level, where they apply to both bounds. Similarly define e.g. $\hat{3} = [3, 3]$.

Equation Systems

We define a series of *entry* interval equations x_i , and a series of *exit* equations x'_i describing the possible values of x before and after the statement i .

$x_1 =$

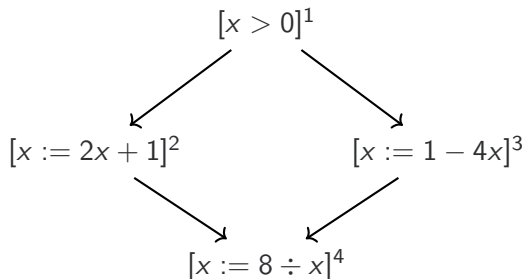


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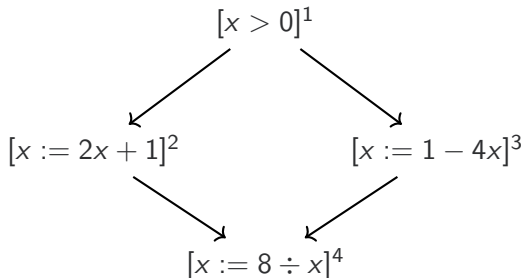
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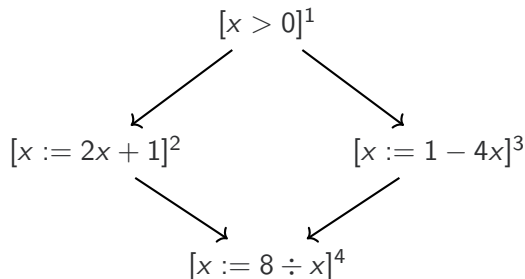
$$x_2 =$$



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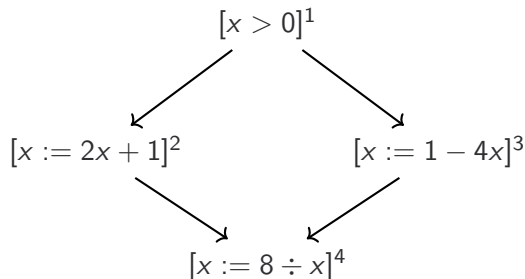
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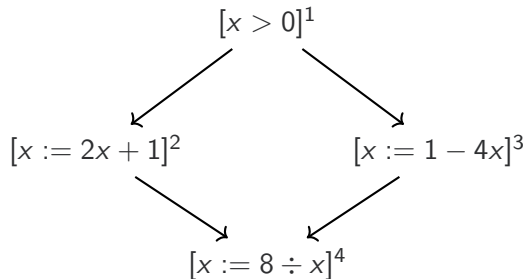
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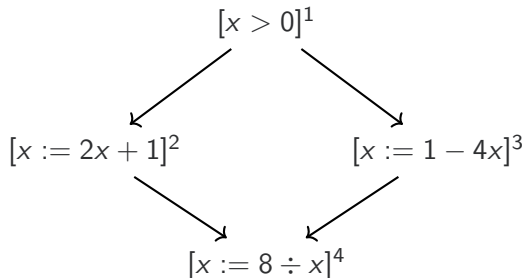
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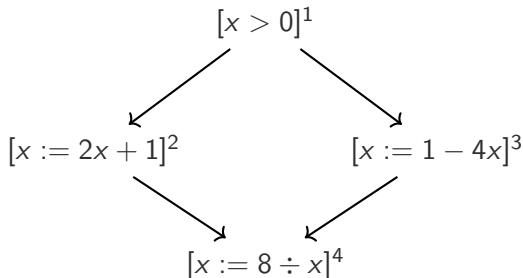
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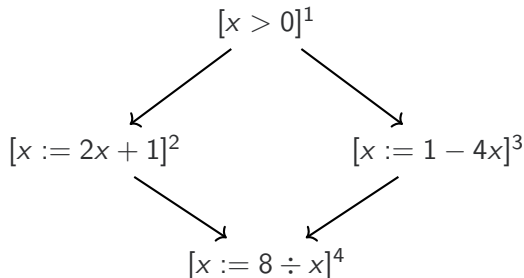
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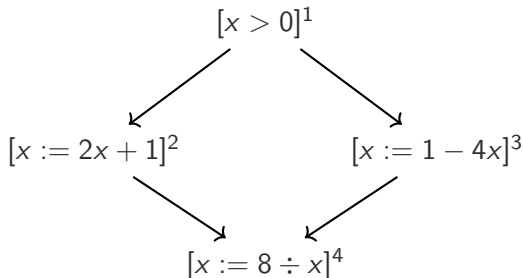
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Observe that all operations used are *monotone*. How can we compute what the intervals are? Iterate to the least fixed point !

Least Fixed Points for Equation Systems

We start initialising all equations to $\perp$, and then iterate until the results stop changing. We can choose the equations in any (fair) order, and we will always reach a fixed point eventually. Some ways are faster than others.

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Seeing as $0 \notin x_4$, we know **divide by zero is impossible**.

Slow Convergence

Because the previous example had no loops, all equations converged after one step. Compare to this example:

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Slightly simplified equations for presentation:

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```

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\end{array}$$

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Because the previous example had no loops, all equations converged after one step. Compare to this example:

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This is going to take a long time to converge! (1000 steps)

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Let n be the value we are updating and m be the result of the next iteration. Then, we update with $n \nabla m$ instead of m :

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In other words, if we ever try to loosen a bound, we just extrapolate all the way to infinity.

This is an overapproximation, but it converges much faster than the normal iterative sequence does.

Loops with Widening

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$$n_3 = \emptyset$$

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Predicate abstraction and ***polyhedral models*** do better in many cases, but are more complicated.

All are based on the same principle of least-fixed point of a system of equations.

Data-flow Analysis

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AEA is a forwards must analysis. LVA is a backwards may analysis.

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Each location in the CFG has an associated gen set, of **generated information**, and kill set, of **information that is no longer accurate**.

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Note: $a := a + 1$ would kill $a + 1$, not generate it. Why?

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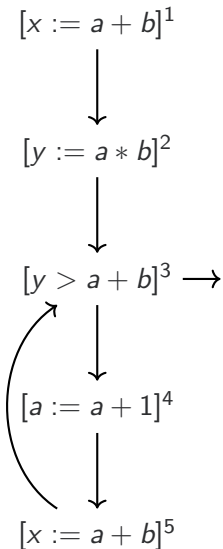
Example (LVA)

In LVA, $\text{gen}_{LV}(\ell)$ is the variables read (and not written to) in ℓ and $\text{kill}_{LV}(\ell)$ would be the variables written to in ℓ .

For example, $x := a + b$ would generate $\{a, b\}$ and kill $\{x\}$.

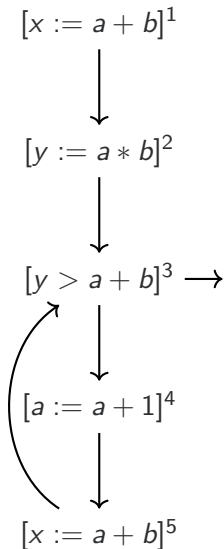
Available Expressions Example

ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1		

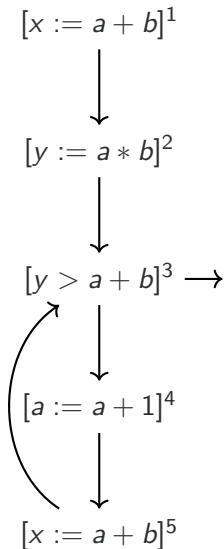


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1	$\{a + b\}$	

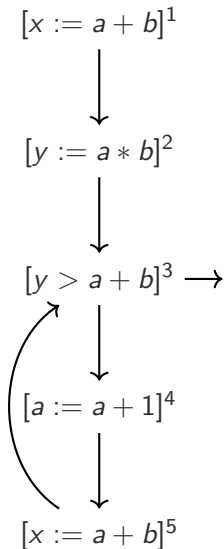


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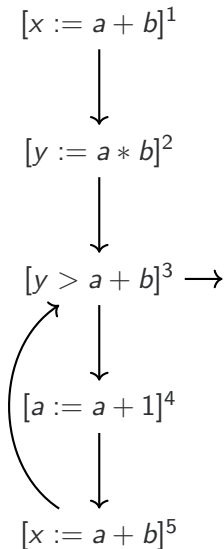
ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2		

Available Expressions Example



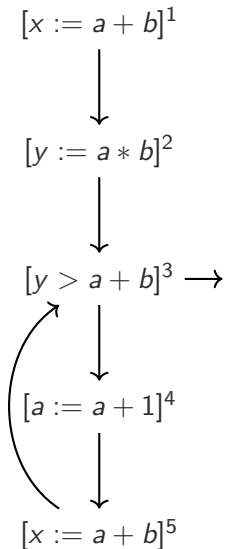
ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
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3		

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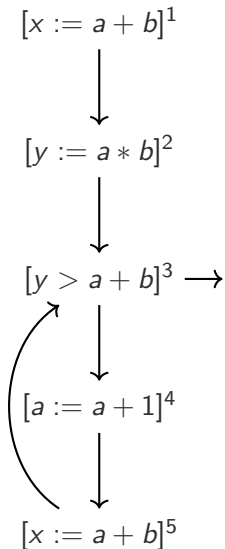
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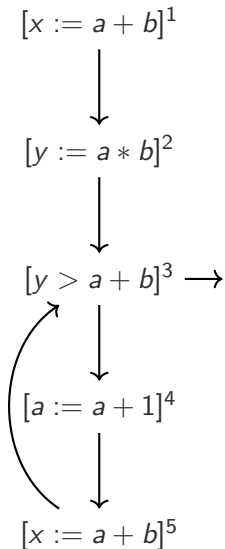
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5		

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5	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$

What to do now?

Specify an equation system that relates these, then find the fixed point!

Forwards Must Analysis

The set of available expressions as we enter a location ℓ is the intersection of all available expressions from the predecessors to ℓ :

$$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell) = \begin{cases} \emptyset & \text{if } \ell \in I_{\text{CFG}} \\ \bigcap \{AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell') \mid (\ell', \ell) \in \delta_{\text{CFG}}\} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

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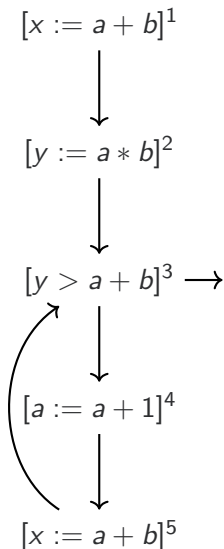
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The set of available expressions as we exit a location ℓ is the set that we entered with, minus anything we kill, plus anything we generate:

$$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell) = (AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell) \setminus \text{kill}_{\text{AE}}(\ell)) \cup \text{gen}_{\text{AE}}(\ell)$$

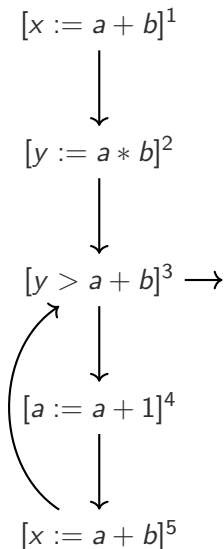
Example for AEA



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ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
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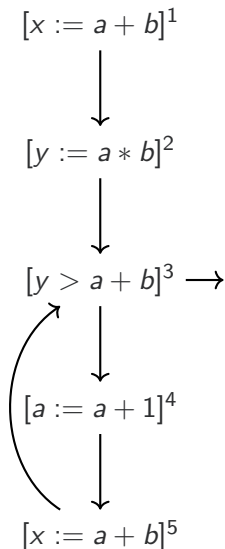
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1	$\emptyset$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(1) \cup \{a + b\}$

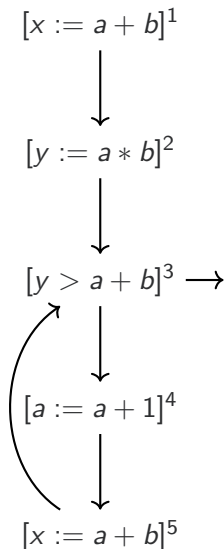
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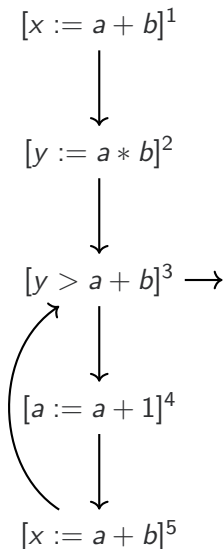
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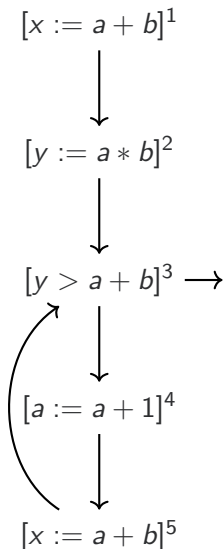
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3	$AE_{\text{exit}}(2) \cap AE_{\text{exit}}(5)$	

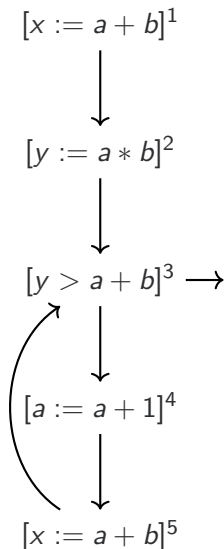
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3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(1) \cup \{a + b\}$
2	$AE_{\text{exit}}(1)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(2) \cup \{a * b\}$
3	$AE_{\text{exit}}(2) \cap AE_{\text{exit}}(5)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(3) \cup \{a + b\}$

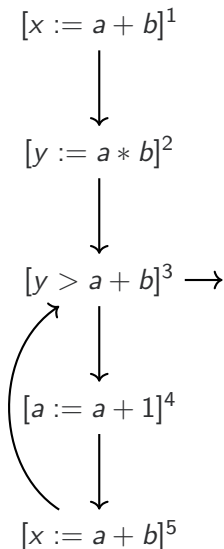
Example for AEA



ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2	$\{a * b\}$	$\emptyset$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(1) \cup \{a + b\}$
2	$AE_{\text{exit}}(1)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(2) \cup \{a * b\}$
3	$AE_{\text{exit}}(2) \cap AE_{\text{exit}}(5)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(3) \cup \{a + b\}$
4	$AE_{\text{exit}}(3)$	

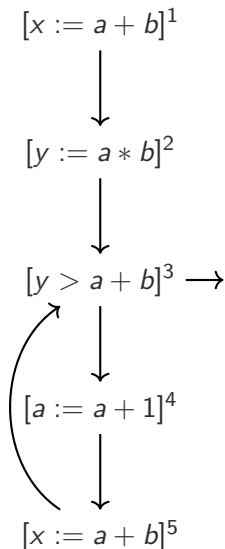
Example for AEA



ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2	$\{a * b\}$	$\emptyset$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(1) \cup \{a + b\}$
2	$AE_{\text{exit}}(1)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(2) \cup \{a * b\}$
3	$AE_{\text{exit}}(2) \cap AE_{\text{exit}}(5)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(3) \cup \{a + b\}$
4	$AE_{\text{exit}}(3)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(4) \setminus \text{kill}_{AE}(4)$

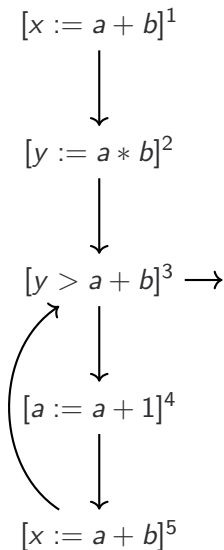
Example for AEA



ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2	$\{a * b\}$	$\emptyset$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(1) \cup \{a + b\}$
2	$AE_{\text{exit}}(1)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(2) \cup \{a * b\}$
3	$AE_{\text{exit}}(2) \cap AE_{\text{exit}}(5)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(3) \cup \{a + b\}$
4	$AE_{\text{exit}}(3)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(4) \setminus \text{kill}_{AE}(4)$
5	$AE_{\text{exit}}(4)$	

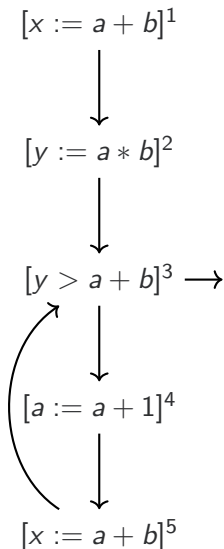
Example for AEA



ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2	$\{a * b\}$	$\emptyset$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(1) \cup \{a + b\}$
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3	$AE_{\text{exit}}(2) \cap AE_{\text{exit}}(5)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(3) \cup \{a + b\}$
4	$AE_{\text{exit}}(3)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(4) \setminus \text{kill}_{AE}(4)$
5	$AE_{\text{exit}}(4)$	$AE_{\text{entry}}(5) \cup \{a + b\}$

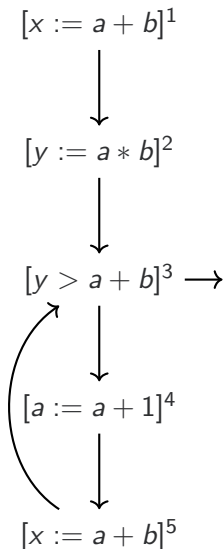
Results



ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2	$\{a * b\}$	$\emptyset$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b\}$
2	$\{a + b\}$	$\{a + b, a * b\}$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\{a + b\}$
4	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
5	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b\}$

Results



ℓ	gen_{AE}	kill_{AE}
1	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
2	$\{a * b\}$	$\emptyset$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
4	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b, a * b, a + 1\}$
5	$\{a + b\}$	

ℓ	$AE_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$AE_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b\}$
2	$\{a + b\}$	$\{a + b, a * b\}$
3	$\{a + b\}$	$\{a + b\}$
4	$\{a + b\}$	$\emptyset$
5	$\emptyset$	$\{a + b\}$

Note $\ell = 3$ can be optimised, as $a + b$ is already computed!

Backwards May Analysis

The set of live variables as we **exit** a location ℓ is the **union** of live variables from the successors to ℓ :

$$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell) = \begin{cases} \emptyset & \text{if } \ell \in F_{\text{CFG}} \\ \bigcup \{ LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell') \mid (\ell, \ell') \in \delta_{\text{CFG}} \} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

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We choose union because we want any variables that **might be** used in a successor to be marked live in ℓ (a **may** analysis).

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We choose union because we want any variables that **might be** used in a successor to be marked live in ℓ (a **may** analysis).

The set of live variables as we **enter** a location ℓ is the set of live variables at the exit, minus anything we kill (write to), plus anything we generate (read from):

$$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell) = (LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell) \setminus \text{kill}_{\text{LV}}(\ell)) \cup \text{gen}_{\text{LV}}(\ell)$$

Backwards May Analysis

The set of live variables as we **exit** a location ℓ is the **union** of live variables from the successors to ℓ :

$$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell) = \begin{cases} \emptyset & \text{if } \ell \in F_{\text{CFG}} \\ \bigcup \{LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell') \mid (\ell, \ell') \in \delta_{\text{CFG}}\} & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

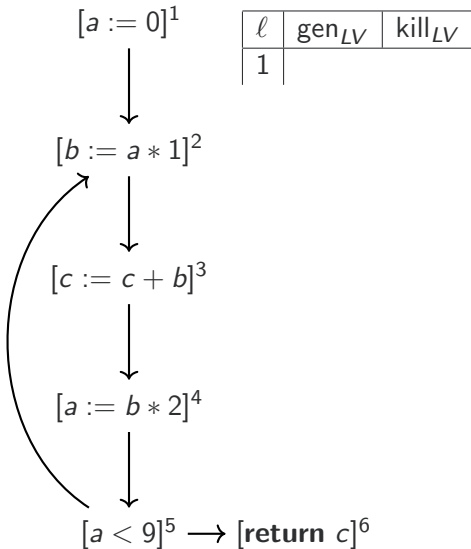
We choose union because we want any variables that **might be** used in a successor to be marked live in ℓ (a **may** analysis).

The set of live variables as we **enter** a location ℓ is the set of live variables at the exit, minus anything we kill (write to), plus anything we generate (read from):

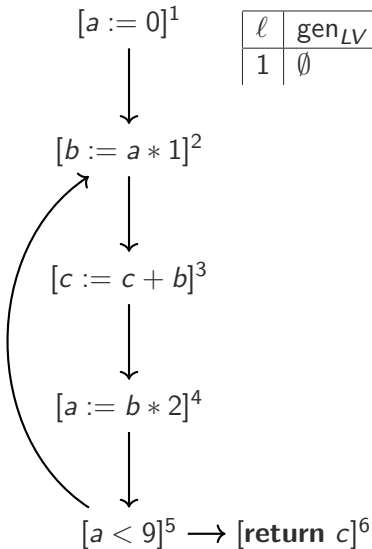
$$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell) = (LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell) \setminus \text{kill}_{\text{LV}}(\ell)) \cup \text{gen}_{\text{LV}}(\ell)$$

The entry and exit equations are flipped because this is a **backwards** analysis.

Example for LVA

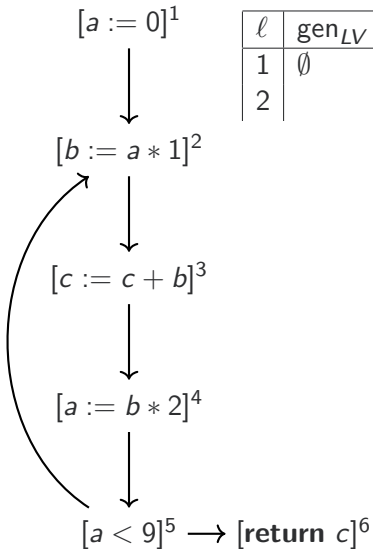


Example for LVA



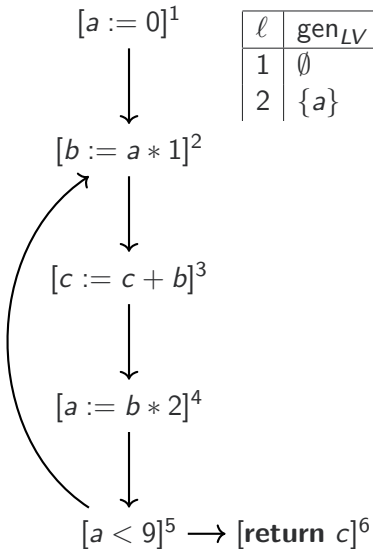
ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	

Example for LVA



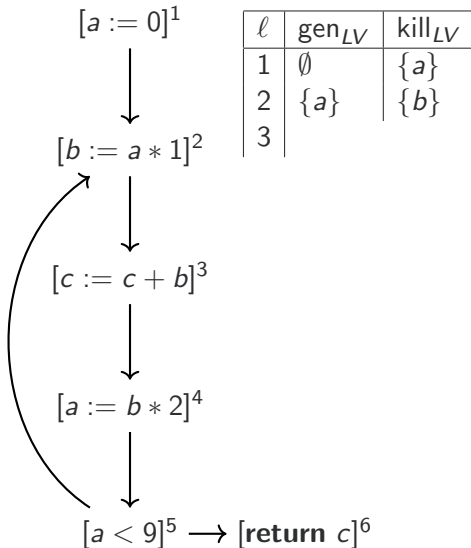
ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2		

Example for LVA

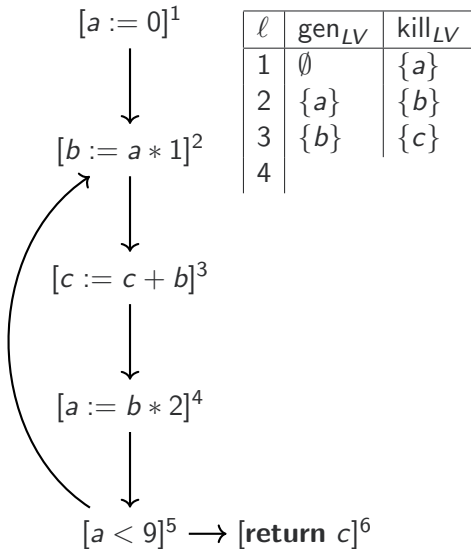


ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	

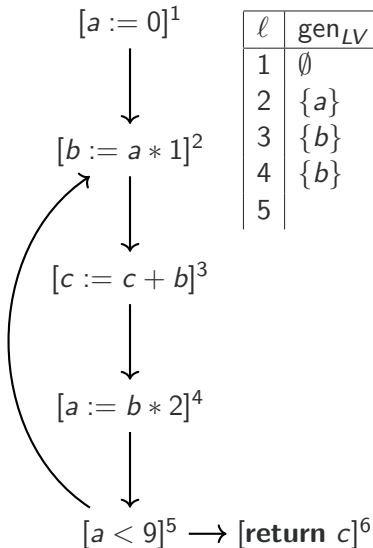
Example for LVA



Example for LVA

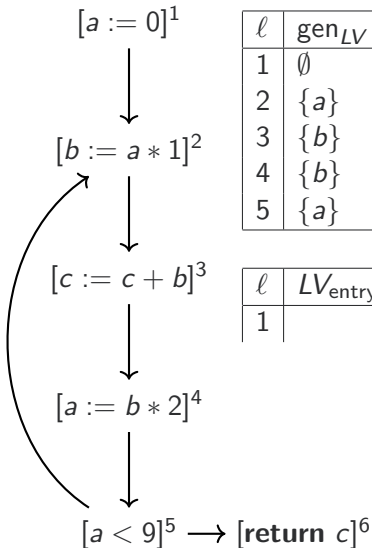


Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5		

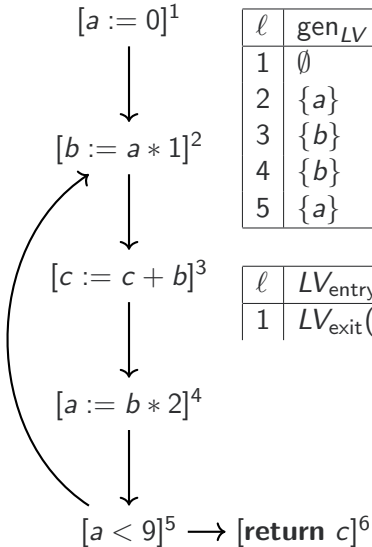
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1		

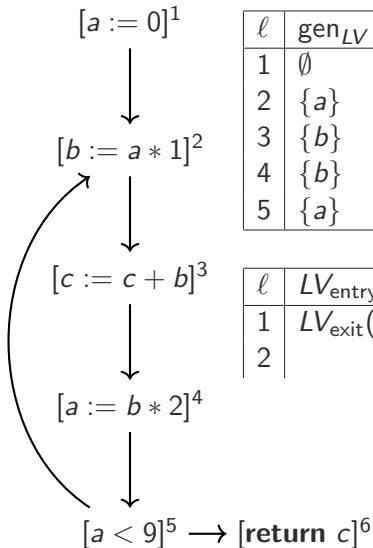
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	

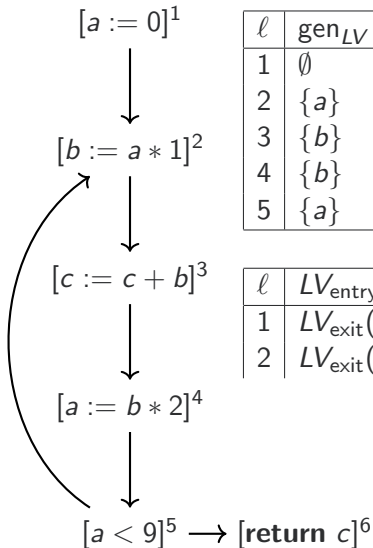
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2		

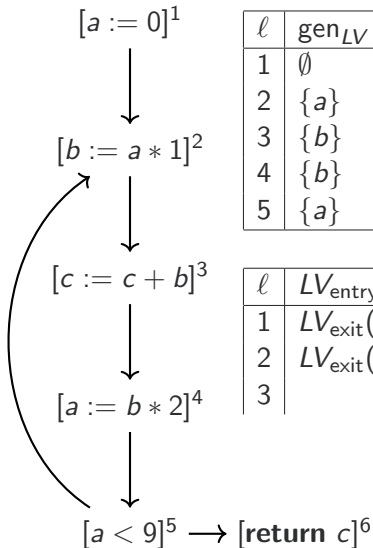
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	

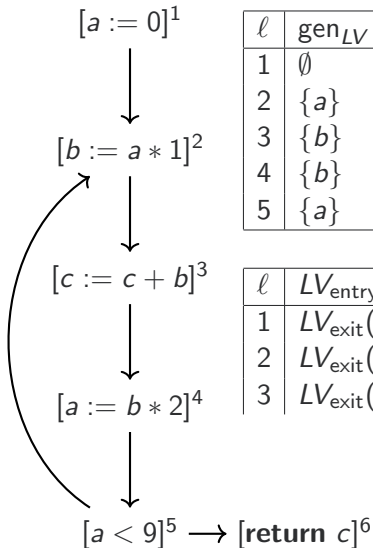
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(3)$
3		

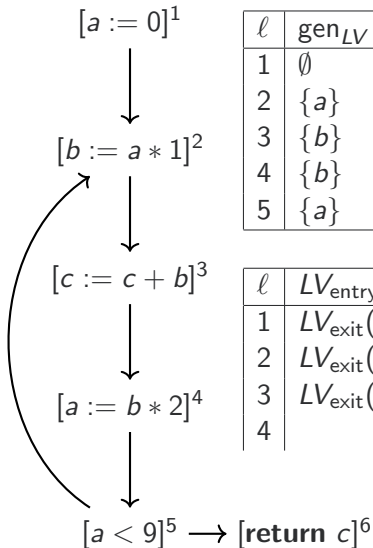
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(3)$
3	$LV_{\text{exit}}(3) \setminus \{c\} \cup \{b\}$	

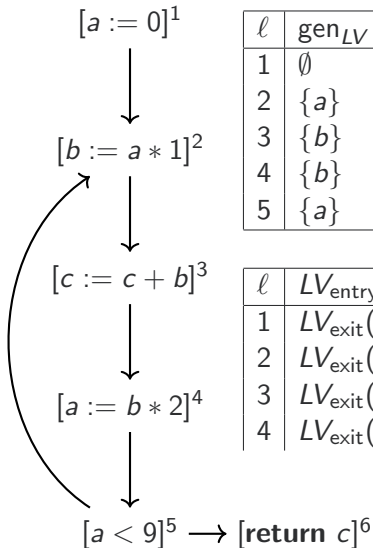
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(3)$
3	$LV_{\text{exit}}(3) \setminus \{c\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(4)$
4		

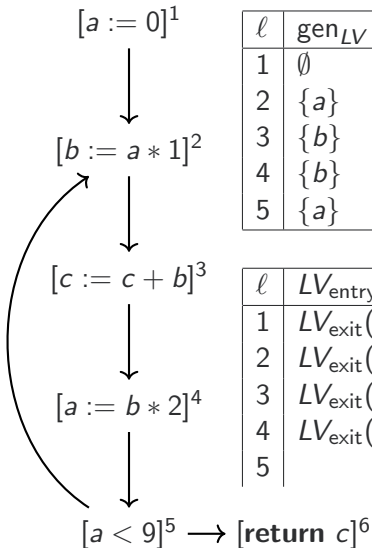
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(3)$
3	$LV_{\text{exit}}(3) \setminus \{c\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(4)$
4	$LV_{\text{exit}}(4) \setminus \{a\} \cup \{b\}$	

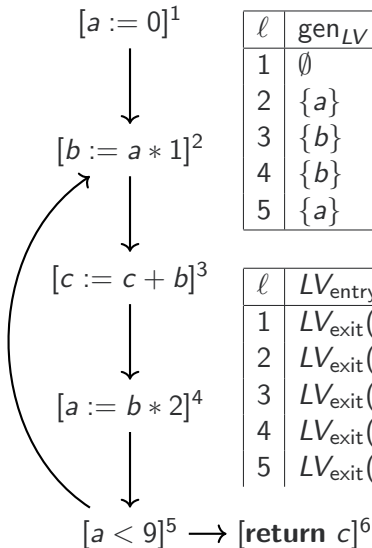
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
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3	$LV_{\text{exit}}(3) \setminus \{c\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(4)$
4	$LV_{\text{exit}}(4) \setminus \{a\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(5)$
5		

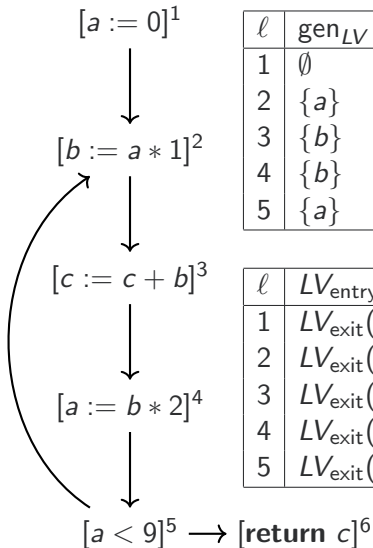
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
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ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(3)$
3	$LV_{\text{exit}}(3) \setminus \{c\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(4)$
4	$LV_{\text{exit}}(4) \setminus \{a\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(5)$
5	$LV_{\text{exit}}(5) \cup \{a\}$	

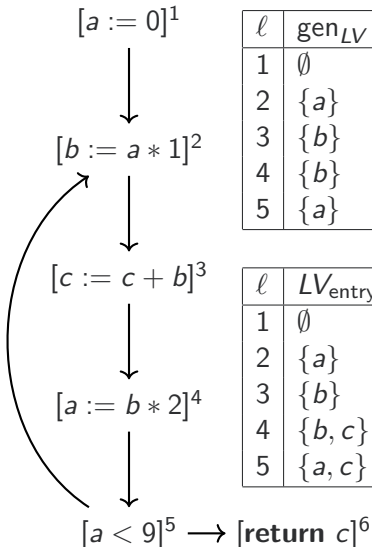
Example for LVA



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$LV_{\text{exit}}(1) \setminus \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2)$
2	$LV_{\text{exit}}(2) \setminus \{b\} \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(3)$
3	$LV_{\text{exit}}(3) \setminus \{c\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(4)$
4	$LV_{\text{exit}}(4) \setminus \{a\} \cup \{b\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(5)$
5	$LV_{\text{exit}}(5) \cup \{a\}$	$LV_{\text{entry}}(2) \cup LV_{\text{entry}}(6)$

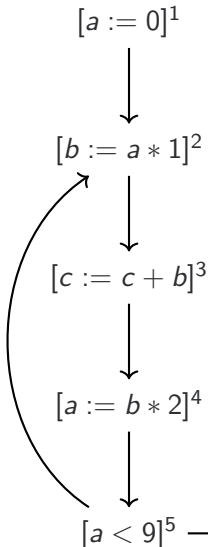
Results



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{b, c\}$
4	$\{b, c\}$	$\{a, c\}$
5	$\{a, c\}$	$\{a, c\}$

Results



ℓ	gen_{LV}	kill_{LV}
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2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{c\}$
4	$\{b\}$	$\{a\}$
5	$\{a\}$	$\emptyset$

ℓ	$LV_{\text{entry}}(\ell)$	$LV_{\text{exit}}(\ell)$
1	$\emptyset$	$\{a\}$
2	$\{a\}$	$\{b\}$
3	$\{b\}$	$\{b, c\}$
4	$\{b, c\}$	$\{a, c\}$
5	$\{a, c\}$	$\{a, c\}$

Note: b and a are never simultaneously live!

Existence of Solutions

Solutions **always exist** to our data flow equations.

Why? Because $(2^A, \subseteq)$ (for AEA) and $(2^{\text{Var}}, \subseteq)$ (for LVA) are both **lattices** and all our functions are monotone. So the Knaster-Tarski theorem applies.

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